PAUL ROBINSON

Heavy Lift Engineer | Mechanical Engineer | Crane Operator

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

A uniquely credentialed Heavy Lift Engineer who bridges the gap between the drawing board and the hook. With a Bachelor of Mechanical Engineering (Honours, Griffith University 2023) and a prior career as a crane operator — completing over 1,500 lifts across all-terrain fleets from 30T to 250T, including Liebherr machines up to 250 tonnes — I bring both the engineering rigour to plan complex lifts and the hands-on knowledge to understand exactly what an operator needs on the ground. Experience developing lift studies, safe work method statements, and technical documentation across high-pressure, safety-critical environments. Proficient in 3D CAD (Autodesk Inventor, Fusion 360, SolidWorks) with strong adaptability to new software platforms. Currently designing and manufacturing adaptive engineering solutions as a consultant, with a track record of bringing precision, safety focus, and genuine industry insight to every project.

KEY SKILLS

Lift Planning	Lift study development, SWMS & JSA preparation, multi-crane lift coordination, safety documentation
Crane Operations	All-terrain slew cranes 30T–250T incl. Liebherr LTM series, Terex Franna pick-and-carry, tower crane erection & dismantling
CAD & Design	Autodesk Inventor, Fusion 360, SolidWorks — 3D modelling, design for manufacture, technical drawing production
Engineering	Mechanical analysis, load calculations, technical report writing, engineering thesis (adaptive device design)
Safety & QA	Zero-incident safety record across 1,500+ lifts, SWMS authoring, on-site risk assessment, OH&S compliance
Collaboration	Multidisciplinary team leadership, stakeholder communication, cross-functional project coordination

WORK EXPERIENCE

Habitec — Mechanical Engineering Consultant *Jul 2020 — Present*

- Design, adapt and manufacture custom assistive and adaptive devices for individuals with disabilities, applying mechanical engineering principles to solve complex, user-specific challenges.
- Produce detailed technical documentation including design reports, specifications, and manufacturing drawings across the full project lifecycle.
- Conduct client assessments and collaborate with multidisciplinary health and engineering teams to develop and validate tailored solutions.
- Deliver training on specialised equipment and assistive technology, translating technical knowledge for end-users and support workers.

Big Lift Cranes — Crane Operator *Dec 2014 — Feb 2015*

- Operated Big Lift's 250-tonne Liebherr LTM — the largest crane in the fleet — performing complex lifts including tower crane erection and dismantling.
- Maintained strict adherence to lift study protocols and safety procedures. Employment period concluded due to sustaining a spinal cord injury.

Select Plant Hire — Crane Operator *Aug 2013 — Dec 2014*

- Operated cranes ranging from 30T to 280T across construction and process plant projects, completing over 1,500 lifts with a zero-incident safety record.
- Played a lead role in developing lift studies and safe work method statements — directly producing the technical planning documentation that underpins safe lift execution.
- Coordinated multi-crane lifts in high-pressure environments, managing communication and precision sequencing with cross-functional site teams.
- Specialised in installation of structural steelwork and process plant equipment requiring precise load management and rigging technique.

NQ Group Heavy Haulage & Cranes — Crane Operator *Feb 2012 — Aug 2013*

- Operated all-terrain fleet cranes (50T–220T) and Franna pick-and-carry units under a Hastings Deering contract specialising in heavy machinery loading, transport, and assembly.
- Accumulated extensive experience in heavy and intricate multi-crane lifts, consistently adhering to lift studies and rigorous lifting and rigging techniques.
- Recognised for expertise in assembly and disassembly of heavy plant and mining equipment, contributing directly to project efficiency and safety outcomes.

AllState Cranes — Crane Operator & Rigger *Mar 2010 — Feb 2012*

- Deployed on major infrastructure projects including the Caltex Lytton Refinery Turnaround and ongoing maintenance program, and the Airport Link tunnel project (Brisbane).
- Completed the Airport Link MEFT Mobile Work Platform assembly, operating in confined underground environments with strict procedural compliance.

East Coast Development Engineering — Rigger & Crane Operator *Feb 2011 — Jun 2011*

- FIFO deployment (4 weeks on / 9 days off) to BHP Billiton's Olympic Dam mine site and the TDU upgrade project, performing rigging and crane operations in a high-safety mining environment.

Hamon — Rigger & Telehandler Operator *Jan 2010 — Mar 2010*

- FIFO deployment (8 weeks on / 2 weeks off) performing Franna, forklift and telehandler operations in a major industrial maintenance environment.

Superior Stainless — Fabricator / Welder *Jun 2009 — Oct 2011*

- Led specialised fabrication projects in stainless steel, mild steel, and aluminium. Interpreted complex shop drawings and executed to tight specifications.

Swift Marine — Apprentice Sheet Metal Fabricator *Aug 2004 — Aug 2008*

- Completed a comprehensive Certificate III Sheet Metal Fabrication Apprenticeship, building foundational trade skills in fabrication, welding, and workshop practice.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Mechanical Engineering (Honours)
Griffith University, Gold Coast | 2023
Thesis: Designed a leg/foot attachment enabling passive cycling for individuals with lower limb paralysis or weakness — combining biomechanical analysis, 3D CAD modelling, and adaptive device prototyping.

Certificate III — Engineering Fabrication
TAFE Queensland, Southport | 2007

Introduction to CNC Machining
TAFE Queensland, Southport | 2023

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

Griffith College Academic Excellence Award | 2017

CTQ Excellence Despite Adversity Award | 2016

REFERENCES

Adam Evans
East Coast Cranes — Operations Manager
0437 444 33

Soo Oh
Habitec — Project Manager
0401 390 359

Jim Barrett
Making Strides SCI Recovery Centre — Director
0401 331 730

Kyle Mulholland
BioSpine Project — Project Manager
0412 366 028